

HEMANT MISHRA

says, "Research-intensive universities are a particular appeal and we strive to create global solutions to local problems by collaborating internationally. We have research strengths that align with India's priorities, including food security, digital technologies, tackling climate change and green energy, and students studying in this area with us from India is hugely beneficial." Data science and Analytics, Fintech, Artificial Intelligence & Machine Learning are fast emerging as new subjects of interest. However, the tremendous job opportunities and the explosion of technology in recent years make STEM (science, technology, engineering and math) fields still the most popular. According to the OpenDoors report, the percentage of international students studying STEM subjects in the US was 79.4 in 2021-2022.

The growing need for healthcare professionals worldwide, the potential for high salaries and career advancement, and the opportunity to make a difference in people's lives are fuelling a rise in those wishing to specialise in healthcare and life sciences. Meanwhile, the increasing awareness of environmental and sustainable development issues is seeing a rise in Indian students choosing Earth, Environmental and Atmospheric Sciences. Medicine, Biology and Ecology, therefore, netted 10 per cent of last year's intake of Indian students.

PRATIBHA JAIN
27, Bengaluru

» **GOING FOR:** Master's in Graphic Design, University for the Creative Arts, UK

» **WHY SHE WANTS TO GO**

"The state-of-the-art facilities and resources at the university are some of the best in the world, which will enhance my overall learning experience. The global exposure and cultural diversity will help me build a network of peers and professionals in the industry"

Specialised courses such as Aerospace Engineering and Art History are also finding takers because of the career opportunities they offer in the global market. Liberal arts courses in old specialities like Literature, Philosophy and Political Science as well as in new subjects such as Corporate Governance, Public Health, Sustainable Development and Renewable Energy attract a substantial number of students, as do disciplines such as Linguistics and Gender Studies. The Social Sciences and Humanities together cornered a 20 per cent share of the students who went abroad in 2022, while business and management programmes attracted 30 per cent of the crowd. "The demand for these programmes is driven by the desire to gain international business knowledge and experience and the opportunity to gain practical experience through internships and co-op programmes," says Ashwini Jain, CEO and co-founder of Foreign Admits, a study abroad platform.

It's not just the international degree. For many, studying in a different cultural environment is itself a part of the education. Studying abroad allows young students to imbibe new perspectives, ideas and ways of life. This cross-cultural experience, says Poshak Agarwal, co-founder of Athena Education, a global undergraduate admissions consulting firm that works with Ivy League and other top universities, helps students develop a global outlook, competencies and a greater appreciation for diversity, not to mention valuable skills for personal and professional growth. Ultimately, however, most Indian parents see a foreign education for their children as a passport to a better career and future. Suneet Singh Kochar, co-founder and CEO of Fateh Education,